

Maria Silva

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LLB and LLM graduate with hands-on experience in property disputes, client-facing case management and document preparation. Practical background includes preparing hearing bundles, maintaining matter records, tracking deadlines and drafting procedural documents at BCLP's Real Estate Disputes team, alongside managing case files and client communications at Citizens Advice East Berkshire. Experienced in supporting fee earners across competing matters with a consistent focus on accuracy, organisation and client service.

EDUCATION

Comparative and International Dispute Resolution LLM — Merit Sept 2024 – Oct 2025

Queen Mary University of London

- Modules covering dispute resolution, procedural issues, evidence analysis and legal research
- Dissertation on data protection and the development of GDPR across jurisdictions — Distinction, 75%

Law LLB — 2:1 Sept 2020 – June 2024

University College London

- Modules included Alternative Dispute Resolution, Advanced Contract Law, Commercial Law and Company Law

International Foundation Programme of Law and International Relations Sept 2019 – June 2020

King's College London

- Awarded the Leaders of Tomorrow prize (top 20 of 200-student cohort; partial funding toward undergraduate degree)

EXPERIENCE

Bryan Cave Leighton Paisner LLP (BCLP) · London Feb 2024 – Aug 2024

Legal Placement Student — Real Estate Disputes

- Prepared electronic hearing bundles and assisted with skeleton arguments and court materials for active property disputes
- Conducted legal and factual research on rights of light, easements, leasehold issues and landlord and tenant matters
- Maintained matter records on iManage; assisted with court filings, matter opening and closure, and deadline tracking
- Prepared client notes and managed large volumes of confidential documents across several matters with competing deadlines
- Assisted with cost comparisons and hearing arrangements, providing practical support to fee earners throughout

Bryan Cave Leighton Paisner LLP (BCLP) · London Aug 2023 – Feb 2024

Legal Placement Student — International Arbitration

- Reviewed and organised evidence for procedural submissions and a Claimant's memorial in a complex investment arbitration
- Drafted procedural orders and procedural histories; amended sections of the memorial under supervision
- Coordinated documents and tracked outstanding actions when sole junior on the matter approaching a significant deadline, helping to ensure on-time submission
- Maintained structured electronic case files and monitored procedural deadlines
- Liaised with the client on required documents; coordinated external Romanian translations
- Received feedback from a partner and associate that performance was comparable to a newly qualified solicitor

Citizens Advice East Berkshire · Maidenhead**July 2026 – Present****Legal Adviser**

- Manages matters end to end: takes detailed client statements, establishes chronologies, drafts correspondence, prepares applications and document schedules, and maintains confidential case records to deadline
- Advises clients across housing, welfare benefits, employment, family, debt and consumer matters, translating complex rules into clear, practical guidance for vulnerable individuals
- Assesses eligibility against statutory and regulatory criteria, identifies evidential gaps and researches complex legal points
- Communicates with clients about procedural requirements and progress, maintaining consistent and careful client care throughout

Q-Legal · Remote**Oct 2024 – Jan 2025****Legal Adviser**

- Managed a data-privacy matter from client instruction through to a formal written advice letter, under a qualified solicitor's supervision
- Researched UK GDPR and Data Protection Act 2018 obligations, identified compliance risks and recommended practical mitigations
- Translated complex statutory requirements into clear, commercially focused advice; coordinated with client and supervising solicitor to meet deadline

Adobe · London**June 2022 – Aug 2022****Legal Intern**

- Reviewed and amended software licensing agreements; identified contractual risks and assessed alignment with internal legal and compliance requirements
- Reviewed confidentiality and data-processing provisions; researched UK GDPR, EU GDPR and cross-border data transfer requirements
- Liaised with sales, legal and international business teams to resolve contractual queries and reconcile commercial objectives with legal risk
- Prepared and delivered an internal presentation on breach-of-contract risks and mitigation measures

SKILLS

Languages: Portuguese (native), English (fluent), Spanish (basic)

Technical skills: Microsoft Word, Excel and PowerPoint; iManage; legal research databases; electronic court filing portals; document review and electronic bundling; case management and time-recording systems

Case and evidence management: Hearing bundle preparation, matter file organisation, procedural histories, deadline tracking, document review, court filing support